



INDEPENDENT CANDIDATE THESIS
BRIEF

Decision Advantage before the mission window opens.

Product Associate Director (Group Product Manager)

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Mission Window Contract: mission outcome + human authority + integration fit + evidence threshold + acquisition path + field-learning return.

Prepared from public company information and verified candidate evidence. No claim is made about undisclosed internal processes.

1. The mandate behind the title

Turn Two Six's expanding Decision Advantage portfolio into a coherent product operating system that arrives ahead of emerging mission opportunities without weakening operator trust, legacy-system compatibility, or team autonomy.

Company moment

- Proprietary product growth and recurring-revenue expansion.
- Helix positions agentic orchestration as a bridge from legacy to AI.
- Sentr turns the orchestration layer into a mission-specific information-operations product.
- SIGMA demonstrates live, cross-agency CBRNE sensor integration.
- Leadership expansion signals deliberate product, engineering, sales, and strategy scaling.

Operating consequence

If product decisions remain local and support learning remains trapped in programs, the portfolio risks duplicated integration work, inconsistent evidence standards, late acquisition positioning, and weaker platform leverage.

This is a source-grounded hypothesis for discovery, not a statement about current internal performance.

Four tensions to manage

TENSION	WHAT MUST BE TRUE	PRODUCT-LEADERSHIP RESPONSE
Frontier AI vs. mission assurance	Speed without opaque or unbounded action	Explicit authority, traceability, evaluation, fallback, and release evidence
Portfolio leverage vs. mission specificity	Reuse without flattening operator work	Shared decision contract; product-specific workflows and outcomes
Empowered teams vs. top-down direction	Local judgment with coherent investment	Clear portfolio decisions, constraints, and feedback cadence
Product economics vs. support reality	Mission support becomes learning, not hidden labor	Instrument recurring support, deployment, and integration patterns

2. The Mission Window Contract

A shared decision record for portfolio bets. It aligns the questions product, engineering, UX, growth, sales, program, support, and mission leaders must answer before capacity is committed.

CONTRACT FIELD	DECISION QUESTION	EVIDENCE EXAMPLES
Mission outcome	Which enduring operator problem changes, for whom, and under what consequence?	Decision latency, action quality, mission completion, risk avoided
Human authority	What may AI recommend or execute, and what remains a named human decision?	Approval checkpoints, doctrine, fallback, auditability
Integration fit	What environment, data, legacy systems, security, and access constraints shape the product?	Deployment path, interoperability, data locality, uptime
Evidence threshold	What proof justifies accelerate, scale, integrate, hold, or stop?	Evaluation coverage, adoption, reliability, support intensity
Acquisition path	How does the customer buy, fund, deploy, and sustain the capability?	Vehicle fit, budget owner, deployment effort, service burden
Learning return	What field signal must change the roadmap or platform investment?	Support recurrence, user behavior, mission results, rework

Portfolio decision rights

Portfolio leadership decides

- Investment thesis
- Cross-product platform bets
- Capacity conflicts
- Evidence thresholds
- Scale or stop posture

Product teams decide

- User/problem discovery
- Solution sequencing
- Backlog detail
- Experiment design
- Day-to-day tradeoffs

Joint decisions

- Release posture
- Human authority
- Mission assurance
- GTM positioning
- Support productization

Scorecard

Mission outcome, product behavior, trust/risk, adoption/support, economics/acquisition, and learning speed. Baselines and targets should be established with the teams rather than invented in advance.

3. Proof, entry, and executive discussion

Verified proof map

Compunetics: advanced electronics, DoD collaboration, R&D/program leadership, engineering, manufacturing, quality, high-reliability delivery.

Vape-Jet: AI-first transformation, support-heavy B2B product environment, roughly 1,000 fielded robots, factory/field/customer/machine signals turned into prioritized work.

DudeWorth: agentic workflow design with retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and governance.

Amazon and ZeusVu: customer-backward launches, operating cadence, regulated autonomous systems, field risk, and governed execution.

First 120 days

1-30: read portfolio, missions, users, roadmaps, support, acquisition, constraints, and team craft.

31-60: establish contract, decision rights, scorecard definitions, three portfolio hypotheses, and AI-assisted tradecraft pilots.

61-90: run Mission Window Reviews with live product decisions; coach PM/UX in the work.

91-120: institutionalize quarterly portfolio review, field-learning return, executive roadmap narrative, and next-bet decisions.

Contribution case

Russell's operating advantage is the ability to connect technical work, product support, quality, field constraints, AI-enabled workflows, and executive decisions while remaining hands-on.

Executive questions

1. Where does Decision Advantage lose the most time today?
2. Which portfolio decisions are unclear or too slow?
3. What platform leverage should Helix create without erasing product differentiation?
4. What evidence earns investment and what evidence triggers a stop?
5. Which support patterns should become product capability?
6. What should be materially stronger after 120 days?